PART OF THE AI-ENABLED ADDIE ORBIT™

Transforming L&D Workflows.

The AI-Enabled ADDIE Workflow Guide for L&D Professionals.

TRADITIONAL VS AI ACROSS ALL FIVE ADDIE PHASES

See what changes when AI is built into every stage of the design workflow: from manual, time-intensive production to faster, more consistent, AI-enabled delivery, with human judgement and guardrails kept in the loop.

- ✓ The AI-Enabled ADDIE Orbit: the methodology at a glance
- ✓ Where AI saves the most time, stage by stage
- ✓ Traditional vs AI, mapped across all five ADDIE phases
- ✓ Governance and safety built into every phase
- ✓ Business impact: faster drafts, less rework, more consistency

5 Phases	**2 Workflows**	**6 Stages**	**1 Framework**
Across all of ADDIE	Traditional vs AI	Analyse to governance	AI-Enabled ADDIE Orbit

Trusted methodology. Modern workflow.

We didn't replace it. We reimagined it for the AI era.

The **AI-Enabled ADDIE Orbit** combines the proven structure of ADDIE with AI-powered workflows, human expertise and quality governance, helping learning teams work smarter, faster and with greater confidence. This guide compares the traditional and AI-enabled workflow across every ADDIE phase, with guardrails throughout.

Your design process as the foundation
Structure, sequence and instructional rigour: the things AI still can't replace.

AI as the accelerator
The right tools, at the right stage, with the right prompts.

Your expertise as the differentiator
Judgement, context and learning science: what only you can bring.

The reality of traditional instructional design.

Instructional design has never been just about designing learning.

Much of the work happens around the design itself: gathering information, consolidating stakeholder feedback, reviewing legacy content, creating first drafts, updating assets, managing versions and responding to review cycles.

These activities are essential, but they are often manual, repetitive and time-intensive. As learning demands increase, many teams find themselves spending more time managing production than applying instructional design expertise.

> **The challenge isn't ADDIE. It's the amount of manual effort surrounding it.**

What changes with AI.

AI doesn't replace the instructional design process. It changes how work moves through the process.

Tasks that once required significant manual effort (transcription, summarisation, drafting, formatting and content adaptation) can now be completed in minutes rather than hours.

This allows learning professionals to spend less time on production and administration, and more time on the work that creates value: analysing needs, making design decisions, validating quality and partnering with stakeholders.

> **The shift is not from instructional design to AI. It's from manual workflows to AI-enabled workflows.**

How to read the comparison.

The following pages compare how each ADDIE phase is typically performed today versus an AI-enabled approach.

The goal is not to remove human expertise from the process. It is to identify where AI can reduce effort, accelerate drafting and improve consistency, while keeping professional judgement, governance and quality review firmly in the loop.

Traditional vs AI: the ADDIE workflow.

How each ADDIE phase plays out, from manual today to AI-enabled

Humans stay accountable for diagnosis, judgement, ethics and impact; AI accelerates the drafting and synthesis.

ADDIE PHASE	TRADITIONAL WORKFLOW	AI-ENABLED WORKFLOW
A · Analyse *incl. discovery*	• Multiple stakeholder meetings and live notetaking • Transcribing and consolidating fragmented feedback • Reviewing large volumes of legacy content • Mapping needs to business processes line by line	• LLMs transcribe and summarise meetings • Assistants extract actions, themes and risks • Rapid review of legacy content; gaps flagged • Needs mapped to objectives and outcomes
D · Design	• Drafting and validating objectives from a blank page • Building learning pathways and storyboards from scratch • Designing activities, scenarios and assessments from scratch • Iterating structure through many review cycles	• LLMs draft Bloom-aligned objectives and outcomes • AI assistants build and sequence blended pathways • Rapid storyboard and scenario generation • Draft activity, practice and assessment ideas to refine
D · Develop *content, visuals, media, interactive*	• Writing copy, guides and job aids from scratch • Rewriting and reformatting for each modality • Sourcing or producing graphics from scratch • Full video production: filming, editing, vendors • Recording narration with voice talent or studio time • Building eLearning and interactions from scratch • Accessibility retrofitted late in production • Long authoring and review cycles	• LLMs draft slides, guides, job aids and microlearning • Content adapted across formats in minutes • AI images, infographics and diagrams • AI avatars, voiceover and scripts (prototyping and controlled use) • Scalable video and rapid prototyping • AI-assisted eLearning builds (Storyline / Rise) • Draft scenarios and branching to refine • WCAG check on generated assets: alt text, captions, contrast
I · Implement	• Building and configuring the LMS step by step • Writing launch comms and manager briefings from scratch • Repeated updates and rework across versions • Limited support for rollout and adoption	• AI-assisted build and formatting • Draft launch comms, manager packs and learner FAQs • Automated, consistent updates across assets • Accessibility and QA review before release
E · Evaluate	• Repeated review cycles and rework • Evaluation squeezed by time and budget • Designing and analysing surveys from scratch • Limited visibility of engagement and impact	• AI drafts evaluation surveys and questions • LLMs summarise feedback and learner data • Analytics surface engagement and improvement areas • Targeted prompts and next steps where data allows
+ Governance & safety *across every phase*	• Compliance checked late, at sign-off • No standard for handling sensitive data • No clear policy for what AI may touch	• Guardrails set up front, access defined • Human review gates at every stage • Accessibility (WCAG) review built in • IP and consent checked on AI outputs • Learner data kept out of public tools • Audit trail for compliance teams

This shows the working governance layer. Fuller controls, data classification, IP, accessibility standards and evaluation, are detailed in the AI-Enabled ADDIE Playbook.

Want to go deeper?

You don't need to be an AI expert. You just need a better system.

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I've spent more than 20 years designing learning across corporate, government and higher education.

When AI arrived, I saw talented instructional designers facing a new challenge: not learning the technology, but figuring out how to use it without sacrificing quality, judgement and good learning design.

That's why I built the **AI-Enabled ADDIE Orbit**: a practical system, with the free **AI Tools for Learning Design** and **AI Prompts for Learning Design** guides, built on the C.R.A.F.T.™ framework, to help L&D teams work smarter with AI without losing what makes great learning design great.

Want the prompts behind the workflow?

The companion guide: **AI Prompts for Learning Design**, built on the C.R.A.F.T. framework.

- Proven frameworks for better prompts
- 11 prompts for slides, scripts and content
- A repeatable system for better AI outputs

Download AI Prompts for Learning Design · trainerfy360.com/craft

Want help choosing the right AI tools?

The companion guide: **AI Tools for Learning Design**, what to use and when.

- The Tool Selector: four questions, the right tool
- A tool-to-task matrix across every ADDIE phase
- A recommended AI stack for L&D teams

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